

Reported Speech

Reported speech (indirect speech) is used to report what someone else said without quoting their exact words. When the reporting verb is in the past tense, the tense of the reported clause usually shifts back one step, known as backshift: present simple becomes past simple, present perfect becomes past perfect, and so on.

Besides tense changes, pronouns and time/place expressions must also be adjusted to match the perspective of the reporter: 'today' becomes 'that day', 'tomorrow' becomes 'the next day', and 'here' becomes 'there', reflecting the shift

in context between the original speaker and the reporter.

Reported questions follow statement word order (not question word order) and do not use question marks: 'Where do you live?' becomes 'She asked where I lived.'

Reported commands use an infinitive structure: 'Close the door' becomes 'He told me to close the door.'